



Advanced package aspects





Licensing report



Licensing report: introduction

- ▶ A key aspect of embedded Linux systems is **license compliance**.
- ▶ Embedded Linux systems integrate together a number of open-source components, each distributed under its own license.
- ▶ The different open-source licenses may have **different requirements**, that must be met before the product using the embedded Linux system starts shipping.
- ▶ Buildroot helps in this license compliance process by offering the possibility of generating a number of **license-related information** from the list of selected packages.
- ▶ Generated using:

```
$ make legal-info
```



Licensing report: contents of `legal-info`

- ▶ `sources/` and `host-sources/`, all the source files that are redistributable (tarballs, patches, etc.)
- ▶ `manifest.csv` and `host-manifest.csv`, CSV files with the list of *target* and *host* packages, their version, license, etc.
- ▶ `licenses/` and `host-licenses/<pkg>/`, the full license text of all *target* and *host* packages, per package
- ▶ `buildroot.config`, the Buildroot `.config` file
- ▶ `legal-info.sha256` hashes of all *legal-info* files
- ▶ `README`



Including licensing information in packages

▶ `<pkg>_LICENSE`

- Comma-separated **list of license(s)** under which the package is distributed.
- Must use SPDX license codes, see <https://spdx.org/licenses/>
- Can indicate which part is under which license (programs, tests, libraries, etc.)

▶ `<pkg>_LICENSE_FILES`

- Space-separated **list of file paths** from the package source code containing the license text and copyright information
- Paths relative to the package top-level source directory

▶ `<pkg>_REDISTRIBUTE`

- Boolean indicating whether the package source code can be redistributed or not (part of the `legal-info` output)
- Defaults to `YES`, can be overridden to `NO`
- If `NO`, source code is not copied when generating the licensing report



Licensing information examples

linux.mk

```
LINUX_LICENSE = GPL-2.0  
LINUX_LICENSE_FILES = COPYING
```

acl.mk

```
ACL_LICENSE = GPL-2.0+ (programs), LGPL-2.1+ (libraries)  
ACL_LICENSE_FILES = doc/COPYING doc/COPYING.LGPL
```

owl-linux.mk

```
OWL_LINUX_LICENSE = PROPRIETARY  
OWL_LINUX_LICENSE_FILES = LICENSE  
OWL_LINUX_REDISTRIBUTE = NO
```



Security vulnerability tracking



Security vulnerability tracking

- ▶ Security has obviously become a key issue in embedded systems that are more and more commonly connected.
- ▶ Embedded Linux systems typically integrate 10-100+ open-source components
\$arrow.r\$ not easy to keep track of their potential security vulnerabilities
- ▶ Industry relies on *Common Vulnerability Exposure* (CVE) reports to document known security issues
- ▶ Buildroot is able to identify if packages are affected by known CVEs, by using the *National Vulnerability Database*
 - `make pkg-stats`
 - Produces `$(0)/pkg-stats.html`, `$(0)/pkg-stats.json`
- ▶ Note: this is limited to known CVEs. It does not guarantee the absence of security vulnerabilities.
- ▶ Only applies to open-source packages, not to your own custom code.



Example pkg-stats output

package/libao/libao.mk	0	autotools target	Yes	Yes	Yes	1.2.0	1.2.0 found by distro	0	Link	CVE-2017-11548	cpe:2.3:a:xiph:Libao:1.2.0:*:*:*:*:*
package/libcue/libcue.mk	0	cmake target	Yes	Yes	Yes	2.2.1	2.2.1 found by distro	0	Link	N/A	no verified CPE identifier
package/libebur128/libebur128.mk	0	cmake target	Yes	Yes	Yes	1.2.4	1.2.6 found by distro	0	Link	N/A	no verified CPE identifier
package/libffi/libffi.mk	7	autotools target + host	Yes	Yes	Yes	3.3	3.3 found by distro	0	Link	N/A	cpe:2.3:a:libffi_project:libffi:3.3:rc0:*:*:*:*
package/libglib2/libglib2.mk	4	meson target + host	Yes	Yes	Yes	2.66.7	2.68.1 found by distro	0	Link	CVE-2021-28153	cpe:2.3:a:gnome:glib:2.66.7:*:*:*:*:*
package/libid3tag/libid3tag.mk	0	autotools target	Yes	Yes	Yes	0.15.1b	0.15.1b found by distro	0	Link	N/A	no verified CPE identifier
package/liblo/liblo.mk	0	autotools target	Yes	Yes	Yes	0.31	0.31 found by distro	0	Link	N/A	no verified CPE identifier
package/libmad/libmad.mk	2	autotools target	Yes	Yes	Yes	0.15.1b	0.15.1b found by distro	0	Link	CVE-2018-7263	no verified CPE identifier
package/libmodplug/libmodplug.mk	0	autotools target	Yes	Yes	Yes	0.8.9.0	0.8.9.0 found by distro	0	Link	N/A	cpe:2.3:a:konstanty_bialkowski:libmodplug:0.8.9.0:*:*:*:*:* CPE identifier unknown in CPE database
package/libmpd/libmpd.mk	1	autotools target	Yes	Yes	Yes	11.8.17	11.8.17 found by distro	0	invalid 502	N/A	no verified CPE identifier
package/libtool/libtool.mk	0	autotools target + host	Yes	Yes	Yes	2.4.6	2.4.6 found by distro	0	Link	N/A	no verified CPE identifier

Packages affected by CVEs	5
Total number of CVEs affecting all packages	5
Packages with CPE ID	13
Packages without CPE ID	30



CPE: Common Platform Enumeration

- ▶ Concept of *Common Platform Enumeration*, which gives a unique identifier to a software release
 - E.g.: `cpe:2.3:a:xiph:libao:1.2.0:*:*:*:*:*:*`
- ▶ By default Buildroot uses:
 - `cpe:2.3:a:<pkg>_project:<pkg>:<pkg>_VERSION:*:*:*:*:*`
 - Not always correct!
- ▶ Can be modified using:
 - `<pkg>_CPE_ID_PREFIX`
 - `<pkg>_CPE_ID_VENDOR`
 - `<pkg>_CPE_ID_PRODUCT`
 - `<pkg>_CPE_ID_VERSION`
 - `<pkg>_CPE_ID_UPDATE`
- ▶ Concept of *CPE dictionary* provided by NVD, which contains all known CPEs.
 - `pkg-stats` checks if the CPE of each package is known in the *CPE dictionary*



NVD CVE-2020-35492 example

https://nvd.nist.gov/vuln/detail/CVE-2020-35492

Known Affected Software Configurations [Switch to CPE 2.2](#)

Configuration 1 ([hide](#))

 **cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:*.~*~*~*~*~*~***

[Hide Matching CPE\(s\)](#) ▲

- [cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:-.*~*~*~*~*~*~*](#)
- [cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:1.0.0.*~*~*~*~*~*~*](#)
- [cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:1.0.2.*~*~*~*~*~*~*](#)
- [cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:1.0.4.*~*~*~*~*~*~*](#)
- [cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:1.2.0.*~*~*~*~*~*~*](#)
- [cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:1.2.2.*~*~*~*~*~*~*](#)
- [cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:1.2.4.*~*~*~*~*~*~*](#)
- [cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:1.2.6.*~*~*~*~*~*~*](#)
- [cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:1.4.0.*~*~*~*~*~*~*](#)
- [cpe:2.3:a:cairographics:cairo:1.4.2.*~*~*~*~*~*~*](#)

Showing 10 of 50 matching CPE(s) for the range. [View All CPEs here](#)

Up to (excluding)

1.17.4



CPE information in packages

package/bash/bash.mk

```
BASH_CPE_ID_VENDOR = gnu
```

package/audit/audit.mk

```
AUDIT_CPE_ID_VENDOR = linux_audit_project AUDIT_CPE_ID_PRODUCT = linux_audit
```

linux/linux.mk

```
LINUX_CPE_ID_VENDOR = linux LINUX_CPE_ID_PRODUCT = linux_kernel  
LINUX_CPE_ID_PREFIX = cpe:2.3:o
```

package/libffi/libffi.mk

```
LIBFFI_CPE_ID_VERSION = 3.3  
LIBFFI_CPE_ID_UPDATE = rc0
```



<pkg>_IGNORE_CVES variable

- ▶ There are cases where a CVE reported by the *pkg-stats* tool in fact is not relevant:
 - The security fix has been backported into Buildroot
 - The vulnerability does not affect Buildroot due to how the package is configured or used
- ▶ The <pkg>_IGNORE_CVES variable allows a package to tell *pkg-stats* to ignore a particular CVE

package/bind/bind.mk

```
#Only applies to RHEL6.x with DNSSEC validation on BIND_IGNORE_CVES =  
CVE-2017-3139
```

package/avahi/avahi.mk

```
#0001-Fix-NULL-pointer-crashes-from-175.patch AVAHI_IGNORE_CVES +=  
CVE-2021-36217
```



- ▶ Buildroot can generate a SBOM (Software Bill Of Material) matching the standard **CycloneDX** format

```
$ make show-info | ./utils/generate-cyclonedx -o buildroot.sbom
```

- ▶ This can be used to document the contents of the build
- ▶ But also for vulnerability tracking, for example in conjunction with tools such as **Dependency Track**



Patching packages



Patching packages: why?

- ▶ In some situations, it might be needed to patch the source code of certain packages built by Buildroot.
- ▶ Useful to:
 - Fix cross-compilation issues
 - Backport bug or security fixes from upstream
 - Integrate new features or fixes not available upstream, or that are too specific to the product being made
- ▶ Patches are automatically applied by Buildroot, during the *patch* step, i.e. after extracting the package, but before configuring it.
- ▶ Buildroot already comes with a number of patches for various packages, but you may need to add more for your own packages, or to existing packages.



Patch application ordering

- ▶ Overall the patches are applied in this order:
 1. Patches mentioned in the `<pkg>_PATCH` variable of the package `.mk` file. They are automatically downloaded before being applied.
 2. Patches present in the package directory `package/<pkg>/*.patch`
 3. Patches present in the *global patch directories*
- ▶ In each case, they are applied:
 - In the order specified in a `series` file, if available
 - Otherwise, in alphabetic ordering



Patch conventions

- ▶ There are a few conventions and best practices that the Buildroot project encourages to use when managing patches
- ▶ Their name should start with a sequence number that indicates the ordering in which they should be applied.

```
ls package/nginx/*.patch
```

```
0001-auto-type-sizeof-rework-autotest-to-be-cross-compila.patch
0002-auto-feature-add-mechanism-allowing-to-force-feature.patch
0003-auto-set-ngx_feature_run_force_result-for-each-featu.patch
0004-auto-lib-libxslt-conf-allow-to-override-ngx_feature_.patch
0005-auto-unix-make-sys_nerr-guessing-cross-friendly.patch
[...]
```

- ▶ Each patch should contain a description of what the patch does, and if possible its upstream status.
- ▶ Each patch should contain a [Signed-off-by](#) that identifies the author of the patch.
- ▶ Patches should be generated using [git format-patch](#) when possible.



Patch example

```
From 81289d1d1adaf5a767a4b4d1309c286468cfd37f Mon Sep 17 00:00:00 2001
From: Samuel Martin <s.martin49@gmail.com>
Date: Thu, 24 Apr 2014 23:27:32 +0200
Subject: [PATCH] auto/type/sizeof: rework autotest to be cross-compilation
friendly
```

Rework the sizeof test to do the checks at compile time instead of at runtime. This way, it does not break when cross-compiling for a different CPU architecture.

```
Signed-off-by: Samuel Martin <s.martin49@gmail.com>
```

```
---
```

```
auto/types/sizeof | 42 ++++++-----
```

```
1 file changed, 28 insertions(+), 14 deletions(-)
```

```
diff --git a/auto/types/sizeof b/auto/types/sizeof index 9215a54..c2c3ede 100644
```

```
--- a/auto/types/sizeof
```

```
+++ b/auto/types/sizeof
```

```
@@ -14,7 +14,7 @@ END
```

```
ngx_size=
```

```
-cat << END > \${NGX_AUTOTEST}.c
```

```
+cat << \_EOF > \${NGX_AUTOTEST}.c
```

```
[...]
```



Global patch directories

- ▶ You can include patches for the different packages in their package directory, `package/<pkg>/`.
- ▶ However, doing this involves changing the Buildroot sources themselves, which may not be appropriate for some highly specific patches.
- ▶ The *global patch directories* mechanism allows to specify additional locations where Buildroot will look for patches to apply on packages.
- ▶ `BR2_GLOBAL_PATCH_DIR` specifies a space-separated list of directories containing patches.
- ▶ These directories must contain sub-directories named after the packages, themselves containing the patches to be applied.



Global patch directory example

Patching *strace*

```
$ ls package/strace/*.patch
0001-linux-aarch64-add-missing-header.patch

$ find ~/patches/
~/patches/
~/patches/strace/
~/patches/strace/0001-Demo-strace-change.patch

$ grep ^BR2_GLOBAL_PATCH_DIR .config BR2_GLOBAL_PATCH_DIR="$(HOME)/patches"

$ make strace
[...]
>>> strace 4.10 Patching

Applying 0001-linux-aarch64-add-missing-header.patch using patch:
patching file linux/aarch64/arch_regs.h

Applying 0001-Demo-strace-change.patch using patch:
patching file README
[...]
```



Generating patches

- ▶ To generate the patches against a given package source code, there are typically two possibilities.
- ▶ Use the upstream version control system, often *Git*
- ▶ Use a tool called `quilt`
 - Useful when there is no version control system provided by the upstream project
 - <https://savannah.nongnu.org/projects/quilt>



Generating patches: with Git

Needs to be done outside of Buildroot: you cannot use the Buildroot package build directory.

1. Clone the upstream Git repository `git clone https://...`
2. Create a branch starting on the tag marking the stable release of the software as packaged in Buildroot `git checkout -b buildroot-changes v3.2`
3. Import existing Buildroot patches (if any) `git am /path/to/buildroot/package/<foo>/*.patch`
4. Make your changes and commit them `git commit -s -m "this is a change"`
5. Generate the patches `git format-patch v3.2`



Generating patches: with Quilt

1. Extract the package source code:

```
tar xf /path/to/dl/<foo>-<version>.tar.gz
```

2. Inside the package source code, create a directory for patches

```
mkdir patches
```

3. Import existing Buildroot patches

```
quilt import /path/to/buildroot/package/<foo>/*.patch
```

4. Apply existing Buildroot patches

```
quilt push -a
```

5. Create a new patch

```
quilt new 0001-fix-header-inclusion.patch
```

6. Edit a file

```
quilt edit main.c
```

7. Refresh the patch

```
quilt refresh
```




User, permission and device tables



Package-specific users

- ▶ The default skeleton in `system/skeleton/` has a number of default users/groups.
- ▶ Packages can define their own custom users/groups using the `<pkg>_USERS` variable:

```
define <pkg>_USERS
    username uid group gid password home shell groups comment endef
```

- ▶ Examples:

```
define AVAHI_USERS
    avahi -1 avahi -1 * - - -
endef
```

```
define MYSQL_USERS
    mysql -1 nogroup -1 * /var/mysql - - MySQL daemon endef
```



File permissions and ownership

- ▶ By default, before creating the root filesystem images, Buildroot changes the ownership of all files to `0:0`, i.e. `root:root`
- ▶ Permissions are preserved as is, but since the build is executed as non-root, it is not possible to install setuid applications.
- ▶ A default set of permissions for certain files or directories is defined in `system/device_table.txt`.
- ▶ The `<pkg>_PERMISSIONS` variable allows packages to define special ownership and permissions for files and directories:

```
define <pkg>_PERMISSIONS
name type mode uid gid major minor start inc count endef
```

- ▶ The `major`, `minor`, `start`, `inc` and `count` fields are not used.



File permissions and ownership: examples

- ▶ `sudo` needs to be installed *setuid* root:

```
define SUDO_PERMISSIONS
    /usr/bin/sudo f 4755 0 0 - - - - -
endef
```

- ▶ `/var/lib/nginx` needs to be owned by `www-data`, which has UID/GID 33 defined in the skeleton:

```
define NGINX_PERMISSIONS
    /var/lib/nginx d 755 33 33 - - - - -
endef
```



Devices

- ▶ Defining devices only applies when the chosen `/dev` management strategy is *Static using a device table*. In other cases, *device files* are created dynamically.
- ▶ A default set of *device files* is described in `system/device_table_dev.txt` and created by Buildroot in the root filesystem images.
- ▶ When packages need some additional custom devices, they can use the `<pkg>_DEVICES` variable:

```
define <pkg>_DEVICES
name type mode uid gid major minor start inc count endef
```

- ▶ Becoming less useful, since most people are using a dynamic `/dev` nowadays.



Devices: example

xenomai.mk

```
define XENOMAI_DEVICES
/dev/rtheap  c  666  0  0  10  254  0  0  -
/dev/rtscope c  666  0  0  10  253  0  0  -
/dev/rtp     c  666  0  0  150 0    0  1  32
endef
```



Init scripts and systemd unit files



Init scripts, systemd unit files

- ▶ Buildroot supports several main init systems: *sysvinit*, *BusyBox*, *systemd*, *OpenRC*
- ▶ When packages want to install a program to be started at boot time, they need to install a startup script (*sysvinit/BusyBox*), a *systemd service* file, etc.
- ▶ They can do so using the following variables, which contain a list of shell commands.
 - `<pkg>_INSTALL_INIT_SYSV`
 - `<pkg>_INSTALL_INIT_SYSTEMD`
 - `<pkg>_INSTALL_INIT_OPENRC`
- ▶ Buildroot will execute the appropriate `<pkg>_INSTALL_INIT_xyz` commands of all enabled packages depending on the selected init system.



Init scripts, systemd unit files: example

bind.mk

```
define BIND_INSTALL_INIT_SYSV
    $(INSTALL) -m 0755 -D package/bind/S81named
    $(TARGET_DIR)/etc/init.d/S81named
endef

define BIND_INSTALL_INIT_SYSTEMD
    $(INSTALL) -D -m 644 package/bind/named.service
    $(TARGET_DIR)/usr/lib/systemd/system/named.service
endef
```



Config scripts



Config scripts: introduction

- ▶ Libraries not using `pkg-config` often install a **small shell script** that allows applications to query the compiler and linker flags to use the library.
- ▶ Examples: `curl-config`, `freetype-config`, etc.
- ▶ Such scripts will:
 - generally return results that are **not appropriate for cross-compilation**
 - be used by other cross-compiled Buildroot packages that use those libraries
- ▶ By listing such scripts in the `<pkg>_CONFIG_SCRIPTS` variable, Buildroot will **adapt the prefix, header and library paths** to make them suitable for cross-compilation.
- ▶ Paths in `<pkg>_CONFIG_SCRIPTS` are relative to `$(STAGING_DIR)/usr/bin`.



Config scripts: examples

libpng.mk

```
LIBPNG_CONFIG_SCRIPTS = \  
    libpng$(LIBPNG_SERIES)-config libpng-config
```

imagemagick.mk

```
IMAGEMAGICK_CONFIG_SCRIPTS = \  
    $(addsuffix -config, Magick MagickCore MagickWand Wand)  
  
ifeq ($(BR2_INSTALL_LIBSTDCPP)$(BR2_USE_WCHAR),yy)  
IMAGEMAGICK_CONFIG_SCRIPTS += Magick++-config  
endif
```



Config scripts: effect

Without `<pkg>_CONFIG_SCRIPTS`

```
$ ./output/staging/usr/bin/libpng-config --cflags --ldflags  
-I/usr/include/libpng16  
-L/usr/lib -lpng16
```

With `<pkg>_CONFIG_SCRIPTS`

```
$ ./output/staging/usr/bin/libpng-config --cflags --ldflags  
-I.../buildroot/output/host/arm-buildroot-linux-uclibcgnueabi/sysroot/usr/include/libpng16  
-L.../buildroot/output/host/arm-buildroot-linux-uclibcgnueabi/sysroot/usr/lib -lpng16
```



Hooks



Hooks: principle (1)

- ▶ Buildroot *package infrastructure* often implement a default behavior for certain steps:
 - `generic-package` implements for all packages the download, extract and patch steps
 - Other infrastructures such as `autotools-package` or `cmake-package` also implement the configure, build and installations steps
- ▶ In some situations, the package may want to do **additional actions** before or after one of these steps.
- ▶ The **hook** mechanism allows packages to add such custom actions.



Hooks: principle (2)

- ▶ There are **pre** and **post** hooks available for all steps of the package compilation process:
 - download, extract, rsync, patch, configure, build, install, install staging, install target, install images, legal info
 - `<pkg>_(PRE|POST)_<step>_HOOKS`
 - Example: `CMAKE_POST_INSTALL_TARGET_HOOKS`, `CVS_POST_PATCH_HOOKS`, `BINUTILS_PRE_PATCH_HOOKS`
- ▶ Hook variables contain a list of make macros to call at the appropriate time.
 - Use `+=` to register an additional hook to a hook point
- ▶ Those make macros contain a list of commands to execute.



Hooks: examples

bind.mk: remove unneeded binaries

```
define BIND_TARGET_REMOVE_TOOLS
    rm -rf $(addprefix $(TARGET_DIR)/usr/bin/, $(BIND_TARGET_TOOLS_BIN))
endef

BIND_POST_INSTALL_TARGET_HOOKS += BIND_TARGET_REMOVE_TOOLS
```

vsftpd.mk: adjust configuration

```
define VSFTPD_ENABLE_SSL
    $(SED) 's/.*VSF_BUILD_SSL/#define VSF_BUILD_SSL/' \
        $(@D)/builddefs.h
endef

ifeq ($(BR2_PACKAGE_OPENSSL),y)
VSFTPD_DEPENDENCIES += openssl host-pkgconf VSFTPD_LIBS += `$(PKG_CONFIG_HOST_BINARY) --libs \
libssl libcrypto`
VSFTPD_POST_CONFIGURE_HOOKS += VSFTPD_ENABLE_SSL
endif
```



Overriding commands



Overriding commands: principle

- ▶ In other situations, a package may want to completely **override** the default implementation of a step provided by a package infrastructure.
- ▶ A package infrastructure will in fact only implement a given step **if not already defined by a package**.
- ▶ So defining `<pkg>_EXTRACT_CMDS` or `<pkg>_BUILD_CMDS` in your package `.mk` file will override the package infrastructure implementation (if any).



Overriding commands: examples

jquery: source code is only one file

```
JQUERY_SITE = http://code.jquery.com JQUERY_SOURCE = jquery-$(JQUERY_VERSION).min.js

define JQUERY_EXTRACT_CMDS
    cp $(DL_DIR)/$(JQUERY_SOURCE) $(@D)
endef
```

tftpd: install only what's needed

```
define TFTPД_INSTALL_TARGET_CMDS
    $(INSTALL) -D $(@D)/tftp/tftp $(TARGET_DIR)/usr/bin/tftp
    $(INSTALL) -D $(@D)/tftpd/tftpd $(TARGET_DIR)/usr/sbin/tftpd
endef

$(eval $(autotools-package))
```



Legacy handling



Legacy handling: `Config.in.legacy`

- ▶ When a `Config.in` option is removed, the corresponding value in the `.config` is silently removed.
- ▶ Due to this, when users upgrade Buildroot, they generally don't know that an option they were using has been removed.
- ▶ Buildroot therefore adds the removed config option to `Config.in.legacy` with a description of what has happened.
- ▶ If any of these legacy options is enabled then Buildroot refuses to build.



DEVELOPERS file



DEVELOPERS file: principle

- ▶ A top-level **DEVELOPERS** file lists Buildroot developers and contributors interested in specific packages, board *defconfigs* or architectures.
- ▶ Used by:
 - The `utils/get-developers` script to identify to whom a patch on an existing package should be sent
 - The Buildroot *autobuilder* infrastructure to notify build failures to the appropriate package or architecture developers
- ▶ Important to add yourself in **DEVELOPERS** if you contribute a new package/board to Buildroot.



DEVELOPERS file: extract

```
N:      Thomas Petazzoni <thomas.petazzoni@bootlin.com>
F:      arch/Config.in.arm F:      boot/boot-wrapper-aarch64/
F:      boot/grub2/
F:      package/android-tools/
F:      package/cmake/
F:      package/cramfs/
[...]
F:      toolchain/

N:      Waldemar Brodkorb <wbx@openadk.org>
F:      arch/Config.in.bfin F:      arch/Config.in.m68k F:      arch/Config.in.or1k F:
arch/Config.in.sparc F:      package/glibc/
```



Virtual packages

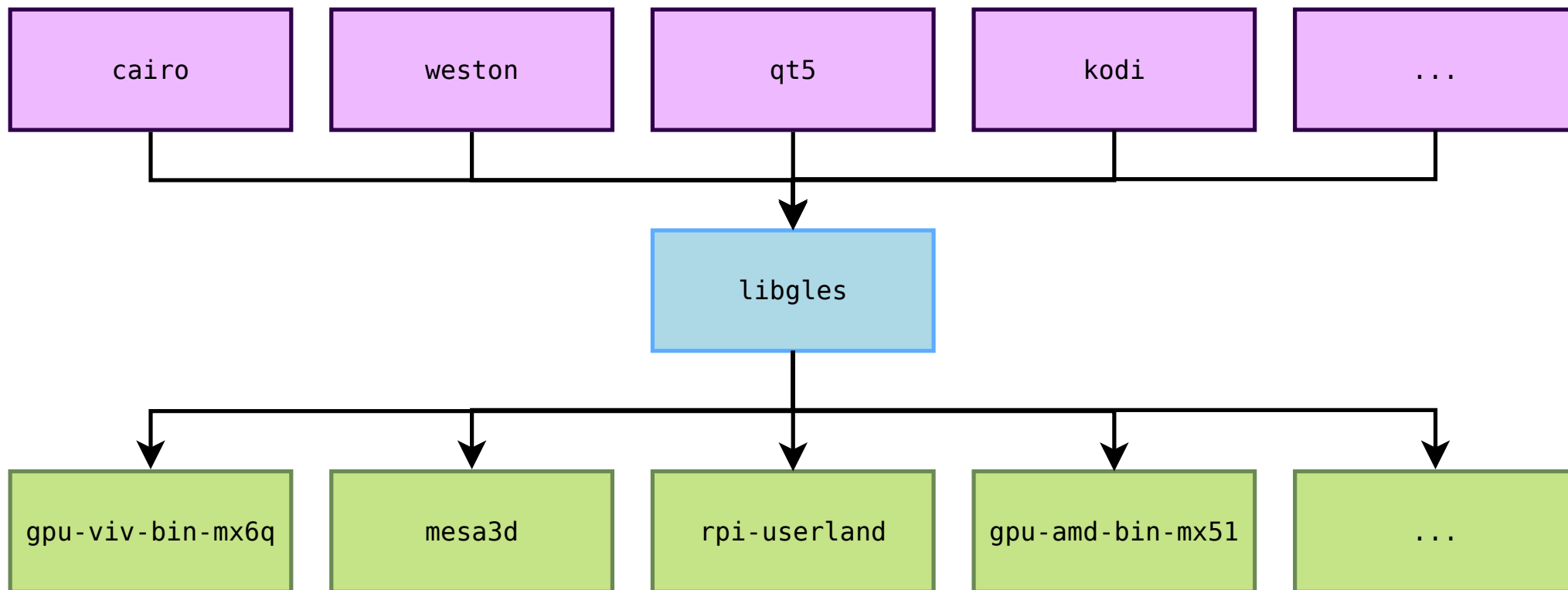


Virtual packages

- ▶ There are situations where different packages provide an implementation of the same interface
- ▶ The most useful example is OpenGL
 - OpenGL is an API
 - Each HW vendor typically provides its own OpenGL implementation, each packaged as separate Buildroot packages
- ▶ Packages using the OpenGL interface do not want to know which implementation they are using: they are simply using the OpenGL API
- ▶ The mechanism of *virtual packages* in Buildroot allows to solve this situation.
 - `libgles` is a virtual package offering the OpenGL ES API
 - Ten packages are *providers* of the OpenGL ES API: `gpu-amd-bin-mx51`, `imx-gpu-viv`, `gcnano-binaries`, `mali-t76x`, `mesa3d`, `nvidia-driver`, `rpi-userland`, `sunxi-mali-mainline`, `ti-gfx`, `ti-sgx-um`



Virtual packages





Virtual package definition: Config.in

libgles/Config.in

```
config BR2_PACKAGE_HAS_LIBGLES
    bool

config BR2_PACKAGE_PROVIDES_LIBGLES
    depends on BR2_PACKAGE_HAS_LIBGLES
    string
```

- ▶ **BR2_PACKAGE_HAS_LIBGLES** is a hidden boolean
 - Packages needing OpenGL ES will **depends on** it.
 - Packages providing OpenGL ES will **select** it.
- ▶ **BR2_PACKAGE_PROVIDES_LIBGLES** is a hidden string
 - Packages providing OpenGL ES will define their name as the variable value
 - The **libgles** package will have a build dependency on this provider package.



Virtual package definition: `.mk`

libgles/libgles.mk

```
$(eval $(virtual-package))
```

- ▶ Nothing to do: the `virtual-package` infrastructure takes care of everything, using the `BR2_PACKAGE_HAS_<name>` and `BR2_PACKAGE_PROVIDES_<name>` options.



Virtual package provider

sunxi-mali-mainline/Config.in

```
config BR2_PACKAGE_SUNXI_MALI_MAINLINE
    bool "sunxi-mali-mainline"
    select BR2_PACKAGE_HAS_LIBEGL
    select BR2_PACKAGE_HAS_LIBGLES

config BR2_PACKAGE_PROVIDES_LIBGLES
    default "sunxi-mali-mainline"
```

sunxi-mali-mainline/sunxi-mali-mainline.mk

```
[...]
SUNXI_MALI_MAINLINE_PROVIDES = libegl libgles
[...]
```

- ▶ The variable `<pkg>_PROVIDES` is only used to detect if two providers for the same virtual package are enabled.



Virtual package user

qt5/qt5base/Config.in

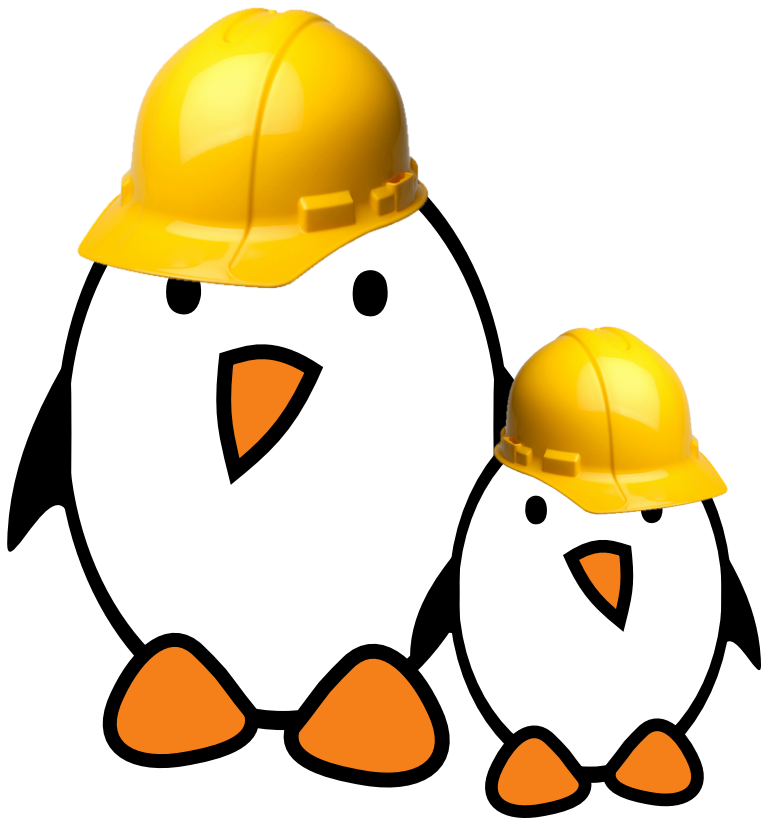
```
config BR2_PACKAGE_QT5BASE_OPENGL_ES2
    bool "OpenGL ES 2.0+"
    depends on BR2_PACKAGE_HAS_LIBGLES
    help
        Use OpenGL ES 2.0 and later versions.
```

qt5/qt5base/qt5base.mk

```
ifeq ($(BR2_PACKAGE_QT5BASE_OPENGL_DESKTOP),y)
QT5BASE_CONFIGURE_OPTS += -opengl desktop QT5BASE_DEPENDENCIES += libgl
else ifeq ($(BR2_PACKAGE_QT5BASE_OPENGL_ES2),y)
QT5BASE_CONFIGURE_OPTS += -opengl es2
QT5BASE_DEPENDENCIES += libgles
else QT5BASE_CONFIGURE_OPTS += -no-opengl
endif
```




Practical lab - Advanced packages



- ▶ Package an application with a mandatory dependency and an optional dependency
- ▶ Package a library, hosted on GitHub
- ▶ Use *hooks* to tweak packages
- ▶ Add a patch to a package